University of Tennessee
Haslam College of Business
ECON 311 Intermediate Microeconomics
Summer 2026, Online
10:00 am – 11:40 am M/T/W/R/F

Instructor: Kaden Grace
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Office: Online: Click this Link
Office Hours: Mondays 10:00 am – 11:40 am, or email me for an appointment.
Final Exam: Wednesday, July 1

Required Materials:

1) **MyLab Economics Inclusive Access for HW and e-text:** Graded homework will be done online. Inclusive access grants you access to Pearson MyLab. In Pearson, you can find an online version of the text Microeconomics, 9th edition (2020), by Pindyck and Rubinfeld. Older editions (8th, 7th, 6th, or 5th) of the paper text may be used as a reference (basic micro theory has not changed much!). Unless you 'Opt Out', the cost has already been included in your course fees.
2) **Notebook/binder with paper and pencil/pen and/or Laptop/iPad/Surface**: These are for taking notes in class. I highly recommend pencil and paper for the examples we go over in class.
3) **Calculator:** A graphing calculator or some type of calculator other than your phone will be helpful for homework, in-class work, and exams. Please bring your calculator to class each day.

Supplementary materials will be provided on an as-needed basis.

Prerequisites: ECON 201 or ECON 207 or ECON 211 or ECON 217.
Corequisites: STAT 201 or STAT 207

Course Description

This course builds upon the microeconomics framework in your introductory economics course. Many of the topics require the proper application of various mathematical tools. You will learn to apply the appropriate tools and theories to make informed predictions about market changes.

Course Objectives

By the end of the course, students will be able to:

- Model economic phenomenon with simple supply and demand graphs.
- Demonstrate proficiency in solving simple optimization problems.
- Describe preferences and utility in a mathematical way.
- Apply mathematical optimization techniques to both consumer and producer problems.
- Describe the economic intuition of the optimality conditions for both consumers and producers.
- Compare actual consumer and producer behavior to economic theory.
- Analyze the welfare impacts of government interventions on an open market.

- Contrast how different market structures affect firm behavior and supply.
- Demonstrate strategic firm behavior in an oligopoly market structure using game theory.
- Identify classical economic theory in real-world public policy, news, or personal experience.

Course Activities

IMPORTANT: Late Work Policy and Personal Responsibility

Your daily responsibilities are to take notes on the lecture, read the textbook, submit your daily participation exercise, complete the online homework, and study for the weekly quiz.

You and only you are responsible for completing the learning activities on time. If you miss a deadline for any course activity without my prior written permission (before the due date), there are no extensions or make-ups. If you are traveling for an officially sanctioned University activity on a due date and require accommodations, you are responsible for showing me the University paperwork in advance. If you have a medical or family emergency, you must obtain a letter from the Division of Student Life (LINK).

Lectures

This class is "flipped" synchronous, which means a pre-recorded lecture will be posted to Canvas on Tuesdays, Wednesdays, Thursdays, and Fridays. You can watch the lecture at any time during the day. This allows you to learn flexibly and allows me to be more available to answer your questions during our class time (see "Asking Questions").

Asking Questions

I want to see you succeed in this course, and asking questions is BY FAR the most effective way for you to learn! I will host open office hours during our Monday class time (which is your quiz day!). I reserve the right to offer extra credit for attending office hours. I am available to meet every weekday by appointment on Teams or over email (see email etiquette below).

Graded Homework in MyLab Economics

The ten homeworks in MyLab are weighted the same regardless of the number of questions, and I will drop your lowest score. MyLab questions require applying the math skills and economic theory from class. Homework will be available at least 5 days before the 11:59 pm deadline on the due date. Homeworks may be done at your leisure once they are posted, and you are encouraged to work with your classmates. Please do not, DO NOT wait until the last minute to attempt the graded homework – do it in advance to allow time to figure out the answers and address potential technical difficulties. Allow for at least 4 hours. If you wait until the last minute and run into a technical difficulty, I will not be able to help!

Attendance

You are required to submit a graded *handwritten* daily participation exercise. This class is math-intensive, and it takes practice, practice, practice! Daily expectations will be posted on Canvas. Lack of preparation will reduce your attendance score. If you miss a class, you cannot receive a make-up opportunity unless you have an official university excused absence.

Quizzes

There are five quizzes worth 100 points each. You are expected to take the quizzes on the scheduled date (every Monday). No makeup quizzes will be given unless you have an excused absence that we discuss in advance. Missed quizzes will be given a score of zero. Your opportunity to start the quiz opens at midnight, and all access to the quiz closes at 11:59 pm on the scheduled date. The quiz will have a time limit. Make sure to start the quiz well before the 11:59 pm closure time. Quizzes will be proctored online.

Final Exam (cumulative)

There will be a CUMULATIVE final exam on July 1, 2026. It will open and close like a quiz. The final exam is optional, and your final exam grade will replace your lowest quiz grade (if higher). In other words, taking the final exam can not hurt your grade and can only help your grade.

Instructor Responsibility

I am responsible for facilitating the learning process for students who are committed to learning. I am responsible for determining the extent to which students have met the stated goals in this course. I am expected to be fair, courteous, and respectful, to be responsive to student needs, and not to discriminate based on race, gender, ethnicity, or sexual or religious preference. Grades are assigned based on my professional judgment of the quality of your work in accordance with the syllabus.

Student Responsibility

I assume each student has read and signed the Honor statement regarding academic integrity in Hilltopics. Anyone in violation of the Honor statement, such as receiving inappropriate academic assistance or copying another student's work, will be subject to the highest penalty, either failing the class or expulsion. You are responsible for your learning outcomes and your performance on all assignments. You are responsible for contacting the professor early in the semester if you are struggling with the material.

Email Etiquette

When composing an email, it is polite to include a salutation, such as "Dear Mr. Grace," as well as your own name at the end. Also, since I have many students, please include your course name (Econ 311) in the email subject. I will do my best to respond to emails within 24 hours, excluding weekends and holidays. I will only check and respond to email within business hours (8:00 am – 5:00 pm). If you email me after 5:00 pm about an assignment that is due at midnight, *I will not see your email in time.* Do not wait until the last minute! If you do not hear a response from me within 48 hours, please resend your message.

Grading Scale

Your course grade will be determined solely by performance. This is a 3-credit class, which means you should expect to devote ~6 hours each week (~one hour a day) to studying economics, not including class time. There will be NO "curve". Please email or talk to me EARLY in the semester if you have serious concerns about your grade for this class (i.e., for scholarships). Economics majors need a C (not a C-) for this class to count towards their major. I will do everything I can to help you better understand the material. There are also many resources listed below to help students navigate the semester.

Assignment Grading Breakdown	**Percent of Grade**	***Grading Criteria**	
MyLab Economics HW (drop lowest)	30%	90−100%	A
Daily Participation	20%	87−89%	B+
Quiz 1 (Chapters 0, 3)	10%	83−86%	B
Quiz 2 (Chapters 4, 6)	10%	80−82%	B−
Quiz 3 (Chapters 7, 8)	10%	77−79%	C+
Quiz 4 (Chapters 9, 10)	10%	73−76%	C
Quiz 5 (Chapters 13, 12)	10%	70−72%	C−
Final Exam (cumulative, optional,	--%	67−69%	D+
replaces your lowest quiz score)		63−66%	D
Total	**100%**	60−62%	D−
		59% or less	F

***Using the laws of mathematics found in an Excel worksheet, I will round your final grade to the nearest point. For example, if you have a 89.5, this rounds to a 90%, or an A. If you have an 89.4% (or the dreaded 89.4999999999999%), this rounds to 89%, or a B+.**

Course Outline (Subject to revisions. Additional details available on Canvas.)

Week	Date	Textbook Chapter	Homework
1	May 26	Introduction, Math Review	Homework 1 (Practice)
	May 27	Chapter 3 Consumer Behavior	Homework 2 (Ch 3)
	May 28	Chapter 3 Consumer Behavior	
	May 29	Chapter 4 Individual and Market Demand	Homework 3 (Ch 4)
2	June 1	***Quiz 1: Preliminaries and Chapter 3***	
	June 2	Chapter 4 Individual and Market Demand	
	June 3	Chapter 6: Production	Homework 4 (Ch 6)
	June 4	Chapter 6: Production	
	June 5	Chapter 7: Costs of Production	Homework 5 (Ch 7)
3	June 8	***Quiz 2: Chapter 4 and Chapter 6***	
	June 9	Chapter 7: Costs of Production	
	June 10	Chapter 7: Costs of Production	
	June 11	Chapter 7: Costs of Production	
	June 12	Chapter 8: Profit-Max with Competition	Homework 6 (Ch 8)
4	June 15	***Quiz 3: Chapter 7 and Chapter 8***	
	June 16	Chapter 9: Analysis of Competitive Markets	Homework 7 (Ch 9)
	June 17	Chapter 9: Analysis of Competitive Markets	
	June 18	Chapter 10: Monopoly	Homework 8 (Ch 10)
	June 19	No class!	
5	June 22	***Quiz 4: Chapter 9 and Chapter 10***	
	June 23	Chapter 10: Monopoly (Coffee Shop Game)	
	June 24	Chapter 13: Game Theory	Homework 9 (Ch 13)
	June 25	Chapter 12: Oligopoly	Homework 10 (Ch 12)
	June 26	Chapter 12: Oligopoly	
6	June 29	***Quiz 5: Chapter 13 and Chapter 12***	
	June 30	Cumulative Review	
	July 1	Final Exam: Optional Cumulative; replaces your lowest quiz score.	

Key Campus Resources for Students:

- Center for Career Development and Academic Exploration (Career counseling and resources; Handshake job search system)
- Course Catalogs (Listing of academic programs, courses, and policies)
- Hilltopics (Campus and academic policies, procedures, and standards of conduct)
- OIT HelpDesk **(865)** 974-9900
- Schedule of Classes/Timetable
- Student Health Center (visit the site for a list of services)
- Academic Success Center (Academic support resources)
- Undergraduate Academic Advising (Advising resources, course requirements, and major guides)
- University Libraries (Access to library resources, databases, course reserves, and services)

Copyright Statement

The instructor of this class owns the copyright to the syllabus, handouts, assignments, quizzes, and exams associated with the class. All presentations developed by the instructor, as well as the instructor's lectures, are also protected by copyright, whether these presentations and lectures are delivered live in-class, shared through Zoom or other videoconference platforms, or uploaded to Canvas or similar sites.
Sharing any of this material without the written permission of the instructor is a violation of copyright law, and is therefore also a violation of the University's policy on acceptable use of information technology resources (UT policy number IT0110). That policy states that students will not commit copyright infringement, "including file-sharing of video, audio, or data without permission from the copyright owner," and that file sharing is a violation of the University's student code of conduct. I will report all such violations to the Office of Student Conduct and Community Standards.

Campus Syllabus

Dear Student,

The purpose of this Campus Syllabus is to provide you with important information that applies to all UTK courses. Please observe the following policies and familiarize yourself with the university resources listed below. At UT, we are committed to providing you with a high-quality learning experience. I want to wish you the best for a successful and productive semester.

–Dr. John Zomchick, Provost and Senior Vice Chancellor

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

Each student is responsible for their personal integrity in academic life and for adhering to UT's Honor Statement. The Honor Statement reads: "An essential feature of the University of Tennessee, Knoxville is a commitment to maintaining an atmosphere of intellectual integrity and academic honesty. As a student of the university, I pledge that I will neither knowingly give nor receive any inappropriate assistance in academic work, thus affirming my own personal commitment to honor and integrity."

YOUR ROLE IN IMPROVING THE COURSE THROUGH ASSESSMENT

At UT, it is our collective responsibility to improve the state of teaching and learning. During the semester you may be requested to assess aspects of this course, either during class or at the completion of the class, and through the TNVoice course evaluation. Please take the few moments needed to respond to these requests as they are used by instructors, department heads, deans and others to improve the quality of your UT learning experience.

STUDENTS WITH DISABILITIES – http://sds.utk.edu
The University of Tennessee, Knoxville, is committed to providing an inclusive learning environment for all students. If you anticipate or experience a barrier in this course due to a chronic health condition, a learning, hearing, neurological, mental health, vision, physical, or other kind of disability, or a temporary injury, you are encouraged to contact Student Disability Services (SDS) at 865-974-6087 or sds@utk.edu. An SDS Coordinator will meet with you to develop a plan to ensure you have equitable access to this course. If you are already registered with SDS, please contact your instructor to discuss implementing accommodations included in your course access letter. You may also contact your SDS Coordinator if you have any questions, concerns, or experience any barriers to using your accommodations in this course.

ACCESSIBILITY POLICY AND TRAINING – http://accessibility.utk.edu
The University of Tennessee, Knoxville, provides reasonable accommodations for individual students with disabilities through its office of Student Disability Services. The university is also committed to making information and materials accessible, when possible. Resources and assistance to support these efforts can be found at http://accessibility.utk.edu/.

WELLNESS – http://wellness.utk.edu/ and http://counselingcenter.utk.edu/

The Center for Health Education and Wellness empowers all Volunteers to thrive by cultivating personal and community well-being. The Center can answer questions about general wellness, substance use, sexual health, healthy relationships, and sexual assault prevention. The Student Counseling Center is the university's primary facility for personal counseling, psychotherapy, and psychological outreach and consultation services.

The Student Health Center has a wide range of clinics and services. Their goal is to provide quality healthcare and assist you in maintaining a healthy lifestyle to support your success as a student. To schedule an appointment, call 865-974-5080. To report a health-related absence visit https://studentlife.utk.edu/caring-for-all-vols/absence/.

Any student who has difficulty affording hygiene products, groceries, or accessing sufficient food to eat every day is urged to contact Basic Needs for support. The Big Orange Pantry, located on the 3rd floor of the Student Union, is a free resource for all students, faculty, and staff, no matter how great or small their need is. Students who need emergency financial assistance can also request funding from the Student Emergency Fund.

Students who are experiencing non-academic difficulty or distress and need assistance should call 974-HELP or submit an online referral. The 974-HELP team specializes in aligning resources and support to students experiencing mental health distress.

EMERGENCY ALERT SYSTEM – http://safety.utk.edu/
The University of Tennessee, Knoxville, is committed to providing a safe environment for learning and working. When you are alerted to an emergency, please take appropriate action. Learn more about what to do in an emergency and sign up for UT Alerts. Check the emergency posters near exits and elevators for building specific information. In the event of an emergency, course schedules and assignments may be subject to change. If changes to graded activities are required, reasonable adjustments will be made, and you will be responsible for meeting revised deadlines.

The instructor reserves the right to revise, alter or amend this syllabus as necessary. Students will be notified in writing via Canvas of any such changes.